

PHENOMENAL CONTRIBUTORS

TO INDIA'S GROWTH ASPIRATIONS

Legacy businesses have endured the test of time. Agile in reinventing their approach makes them relevant through all ages. Traditional family businesses are innate to India's economic growth stories and aspirations shaping generations, socially and professionally. Today, its educated Gen X and Gen Z, are rewriting the script to lead the Viksit Bharat 2047 vision with corporate panache!

Family business is a phenomenon. When family members sit together at the dining table eating and sharing experiences, you know that all is well in the business house. Some have existed from the pre-independence era and are now entrenched deep into the business landscape of the country with their invaluable contribution. Theirs is a story of resilience, reinvention and repackaging to stay relevant at all times. The names that stand out as global class conglomerates are the TATA's, Birlas, Godrej, Hindujas, Kirloskars, Goenkas, JK Group, Dabur, Mahindra & Mahindra, MTR, Parle G, ITC and many other others. They raised capital and nurtured underserved communities handholding them to become part of India's economic process. Lineage is timeless.

If a futuristic outlook, building trusted industry and customer relationships, strong and stable leadership, commitment to values, open to adopt new technologies, forging new partnerships are fundamental to industry and nation-building, these legacy business have done it all. Irrespective of changing times and challenges, their social commitment never wavered offering hope to many lives. Economic development is interlinked to social development and vice versa. This symbiotic cycle of building businesses and building human capital owes to these family businesses who have gone beyond pecuniary gains and self-interest.

Today's thriving business sectors owe their success to their immense contribution facing challenges up-front that has paved a tested and safe path for the rest of the new entrepreneurs over the decades to walk on. As pioneers of their industry, they gave spine to India's economy and its global reputation that stands on their entrepreneurial daring! They have proved their gigantic capabilities is all encompassing and the enduring value that they give to all stakeholders linked or involved with them. Family businesses offer stability as they are not a flash-in-the-pan like many start-ups that have come and gone without a whimper. It is the enduring tenacity that has failed to make legacy businesses look jaded in an era of mind-boggling tech evolution and glamour. Cautious, they play their cards well.

Coming out of the shadows of a set pattern of family business, the new generation heirs of legacy businesses are far more adventurous and aspirational. Many of them have been educated in ivy-league institutions in the country and even abroad, which has widened their perception and ambition to go global. Tech-savvy, they are increasingly initiating modernization in family businesses. They are at the right era where traditional wisdom, technology advancements and rising disposable incomes and aspirations in Tier-II and Tier-III cities gives them a wide playing field. Technology is closing communication gaps and opening new growth avenues for them to diversify and expand their businesses. They are reimagining business models, exploring new market techniques and venturing into global markets, a pattern that is a common work ethos among the millennial from traditional family businesses.

Family businesses indulge their new generations to explore, experiment to improve on or start their own ventures, offering a safety net of funding, experience and knowledge passed down by the seniors. Most new entrants in the business world are not fortunate to have such support. If unicorns are celebrated, iconic legacy businesses have created the grounds for most celebration!